

“There is a huge dearth of open source professionals, particularly in north India”



Naukri.com, one of the leading job portals in India, swears by open source technology. The tech team at Naukri uses open source technology day in and day out. But do they get enough people to make working on open source a smooth operation? The answer is 'No'. **Vibhore Sharma, chief technology officer, Naukri.com**, opines that there is huge demand for open source talent but not enough supply. In an exclusive tête-à-tête with **Diksha P Gupta from Open Source For You**, Sharma threw light on the hiring scene at the company.

Q Why did you choose to deploy open source technology?

Initially, when the site was launched, UNIX was the open source alternative. Frankly, we did not have enough money, so we started off with something that was available for free. Later, it became our philosophy because we realised that whatever we saved would be what we earned. We use whatever technology is freely available because we don't want to spend money on buying licences. We carried on with the same philosophy even when we started earning money because we did not find any merit in buying software when whatever was available in open source was good enough. Open source allows one to be self-reliant. You don't have to wait for a third party to solve your problems. You just need to dive deep into the code and find your solution.

We began with open source in 2001-2002. It was not too difficult for me to convince the people around me, though they had no idea of what technology it was. But since it was free and it did not rock the boat, they gave me the go-ahead.

Q Did you get the right kind of professionals to go with your plans?

No, we still don't. There is a huge dearth of open source professionals, particularly in north India. It is slightly better in south India, especially Bangalore. So we actually go to that part of the country for our hiring. We had earlier tried hiring in this part of the country but for the past couple of years, we have started going south.

Q What kind of talent do you hire?

We don't essentially hire people with expertise in open source technology. We either hire freshers or people with 1-2 years of experience. A little knowledge of open source technology is an added advantage. When we bring people on board, we coach and train them on the platforms we use. We basically look at the programming skills of a candidate. We prefer those with experience in something open like Java or PHP. That's how we start.